

Grill Deep Clean & Degreasing

Document owner: Priya Nair (Sous Chef, Grill)

Summary: Weekly degrease of grill, flat-top and hood filters; monthly hood service.

Scope, Frequency, and Standards

- Applies to Grill station equipment: charbroiler grates, flat-top, drip pans, under-grill, and hood filters.
- Weekly: full degrease of grill and flat-top; hood filters run through dish machine; grease traps emptied and cleaned.
- Monthly: hood service clean (duct lips, plenum faces, fan shroud exterior).
- The hood suppression system is inspected by the vendor every 6 months (sticker on the hood).

Safety, Lockout, and PPE

- Wear cut-resistant gloves, heat-resistant gloves, apron, eye protection.
- Gas off = at the line valve. Confirm pilots out and knobs in OFF.
- Never apply water or degreaser above 150°F. Steam and caustic burn risk.
- Keep electrical cords and outlets away from wet zones. Floor is slippery—place wet floor signs.

Tools, Chemicals, and Setup

- Tools: grill tongs, wire brush, grill bricks, scraper, scouring pads, nylon brush, 5-gal bus tubs, towels, squeegee, razor for carbon edges, buckets, measuring cup.
- Chemicals: heavy-duty food-service degreaser (label-use dilution), hot rinse water, neutralizing rinse (clean water), high-smoke-point oil (canola).
- Set up: two-bay system for grates (degrease soak, rinse), dish racks for filters, lined waste bin for grease solids.

Weekly Deep Clean Procedure

1. Shut off gas at the line valve; let surfaces cool below 150°F.
 - Verify with surface thermometer or instant-read at plate edge.
 - Pull all food, pans, and utensils off the station.
2. Remove grates, soak in degreaser 30 min, scrub, rinse, oil lightly.
 - Fully submerge grates in bus tub with degreaser. Agitate halfway through.

- Scrub with wire brush, then nylon to finish. Rinse with hot water. Dry completely.
 - Wipe a thin film of oil to prevent rust; no pooling.
3. Scrape flat-top, apply grill brick, season with oil.
 - Push debris to grease trough. Empty trough before it overflows.
 - Use grill brick with light oil to lift carbon. Wipe to a clean, light sheen.
 - Final thin oil coat; no smoke point testing until next heat-up.
 4. Hood filters go through the dish machine on the pots cycle.
 - Knock off loose grease into waste bin before loading.
 - Load filters vertically, staggered for spray reach. Run pots cycle.
 - Air-dry fully; do not reinstall dripping filters.
 5. Empty and clean grease traps; log on the cleaning chart.
 - Wear PPE. Lift screens; remove solids to lined bin. Wash, rinse, and air-dry parts.
 - Wipe trap cavity; no standing water left. Reassemble correctly.
 - Sign and time-stamp the cleaning chart.

Monthly Hood Service (Cleaning Tasks)

- With line off and cool, remove filters and wipe the plenum faces and duct lips reachable without tools using degreaser and towels; do not spray into ducts.
- Clean the hood light lenses and trim; dry fully before reinstalling.
- Wipe the fan shroud exterior and accessible seams; do not access the roof or interior fans.
- Inspect filter frames for warping and broken mesh; tag any failures for replacement.
- Reinstall filters in correct order, baffles vertical and arrow up.

Quality Targets and Key Limits

Item	Target/Limit	How to Verify
Surface temp before chemicals	Below 150°F	Surface or IR thermometer
Grate soak time	30 min	Timer set at start
Filter wash	Pots cycle	Machine display/cycle selection
Oil film	Thin, even, no pooling	Visual check with towel

Reassembly and Heat-Up

6. Reinstall dry grates and dry hood filters.
7. Open gas at the line valve. Relight pilots per station procedure.
8. Bring surfaces to medium heat to set oil seasoning; no food for 10 minutes.
9. Wipe any residual oil drips from troughs and edges.

What to Do If

- Filter won't come clean after pots cycle:
 - Run one additional pots cycle. If still greasy, soak in degreaser 15 minutes, scrub, rinse, then rerun. Tag for replacement if mesh is clogged or bent.
- Degreaser contact causes white haze on flat-top:
 - Rinse, dry, re-brick with light oil, re-season. Avoid over-concentrated solution next time.
- Gas odor detected:
 - Do not relight. Close line valve, evacuate immediate area, notify MOD and Priya Nair.
- Grease trap smell persists after cleaning:
 - Recheck assembly orientation, clean surrounding floor drain grates, and pour 1 qt hot water down the trap to flush.

End-of-Job Checks and Documentation

- Station passes white-towel test: swipe towel comes off light, not brown/black.
- No drips in hood plenum; filters seated flat; lights clean.
- Floors around grill degreased and rinsed; wet floor signs removed when dry.
- Complete cleaning chart entries for grates, flat-top, filters, grease traps. Initials required.

Common Errors to Avoid

- Spraying degreaser onto hot metal above 150°F.
- Reinstalling wet filters or grates (rust, drip hazards).
- Pooling oil on the flat-top (flares, off flavors).
- Skipping grease trap cleaning; it backs up under heat.

Quick Schedule Reference

Task	Frequency	Owner
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Grill and flat-top degrease	Weekly	Grill line cook on closing
Hood filters, pots cycle	Weekly	Grill line cook with Dish
Grease traps empty/clean	Weekly	Grill line cook; log required
Hood service wipe (plenum faces, light lenses, shroud exterior)	Monthly	Grill lead on prep day
Suppression system vendor inspection	Every 6 months	Outside vendor (see sticker)